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Joseph Barnby

(1838-96)

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Here, O my Lord, I see Thee face to face

Horatio Bonar

(1808-89)



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1 Here, O my Lord, I see Thee face to face;
 Here would we touch and handle things unseen;
 Here grasp with firmer hand eternal grace
 And all my weariness upon Thee lean.

2 Here would I feed upon the bread of God,
 Here drink with Thee the royal wine of heaven;
 Here would I lay aside each earthly load,
 Here taste afresh the calm of sin forgiven.

3 This is the hour of banquet and of song;
 This is the heavenly table spread for me;
 Here let me feast, and feasting, still prolong
 The brief, bright hour of fellowship with Thee.

4 Too soon we rise, the symbols disappear;
 The feast, though not the love, is past and done;
 Gone are the bread and wine, but Thou art here,
 Nearer than ever, still my Shield and Sun.

5 Feast after feast thus comes, and passes by;
 Yet passing, points to the glad feast above;
 Giving sweet foretaste of the festal joy,
 The Lamb's great bridal feast of bliss and love.